

Health, Safety & Wellbeing Policy

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1. POLICY STATEMENT

Overleaf Publishers Ltd is committed to providing and maintaining, so far as is reasonably practicable, a safe and healthy working environment for all directors, employees, contractors, learners, and any other persons affected by our activities. We accept our legal obligations under the Health and Safety at Work etc. Act 1974, the Management of Health and Safety at Work Regulations 1999, and all applicable subordinate legislation. This policy reflects a structured occupational health and safety management framework and commits the organisation to the systematic identification, assessment, and control of workplace hazards; active consultation with workers; monitoring and continual improvement of health and safety performance; and full compliance with applicable legal and other requirements.

This commitment extends to learners: all course content reinforces a safety-first culture, and the theoretical knowledge delivered through Chainsaw Courses is explicitly a prerequisite to — not a substitute for — NPTC-accredited practical competence assessment.

2. SCOPE AND ORGANISATIONAL CONTEXT

This policy applies to: all staff, directors, and contractors engaged in course development, content review, platform maintenance, administration, and learner support; the Chainsaw Courses eLearning platform and all associated digital and physical operations; learners accessing the platform, to the extent of health and safety guidance provided through course content; and any third parties interacting with the organisation's premises or systems.

Our primary operational context is a remote-first, digitally delivered eLearning business. Physical activities are limited to desk-based content development. Principal external risks include legislative changes requiring urgent content updates, cyber threats to learner data and platform availability, and reputational risk from inaccurate safety-critical course content.

3. LEGAL FRAMEWORK

LEGISLATION / GUIDANCE	APPLICATION
Health and Safety at Work etc. Act 1974	Overarching duty of care to employees, contractors, and affected persons
Management of H&S at Work Regulations 1999	Risk assessment, planning, organisation, monitoring, and review
Display Screen Equipment Regulations 1992	Workstation assessment and rest breaks for screen-based workers
Manual Handling Operations Regulations 1992	Assessment and reduction of manual handling risk



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RIDDOR 2013	Statutory reporting of injuries, dangerous occurrences, and occupational diseases
Electricity at Work Regulations 1989	Safe use of electrical equipment
Working Time Regulations 1998	Maximum working hours, rest breaks, and annual leave
Equality Act 2010	Reasonable adjustments for disabled workers
First Aid at Work Regulations 1981	Provision of first aid equipment and trained personnel
HSE / FISA Chainsaw Safety Guidance Series	Currency and accuracy of all chainsaw safety course content
COSHH Regulations 2002	Assessment of hazardous substances relevant to course content accuracy

4. ROLES AND RESPONSIBILITIES

Director / Managing Director:

- Ultimate accountability for all health and safety performance across the organisation.
- Setting, communicating, implementing, and reviewing health and safety policy and objectives.
- Allocating sufficient resources — financial, time, and personnel — to fulfil all health and safety obligations.
- Signing off risk assessments, safe systems of work, and emergency plans.
- Ensuring all staff and contractors are trained, competent, and have received role-specific health and safety briefings.
- Conducting formal annual management reviews of health and safety performance.
- Liaising with enforcing authorities (HSE, Local Authority Environmental Health) as required.
- Ensuring all RIDDOR-notifiable events are reported to the HSE within statutory timescales.

Content Authors and Course Contributors:

- Ensuring all safety-critical course content is accurate, current, and aligned with HSE/FISA guidance and UK legislation.
- Notifying the Director without delay of any identified inaccuracy in course content that could affect learner safety.
- Completing annual workstation self-assessments and reporting ergonomic concerns to the Director.
- Attending all required health and safety briefings, inductions, and training events.

Contractors and Third Parties:

- Complying with this policy and all associated procedures during engagement.
- Providing evidence of appropriate training, public liability insurance, and competence prior to commencement.
- Reporting any incident, near-miss, or hazard identified during their engagement without delay.

Learners:

- Completing the digital waiver and engaging with all health and safety content in the course.

- Understanding that the Chainsaw Courses platform provides theoretical knowledge only — practical chainsaw operations must be conducted under a competent instructor until NPTC competence is formally assessed and certified.
- Reporting concerns about course content accuracy to info@chainsawcourses.com.

5. HAZARD IDENTIFICATION, RISK ASSESSMENT, AND CONTROL

Hazards are identified and risks assessed using a likelihood × severity matrix (1–5 scale): Low 1–4, Medium 5–12, High 13–18, Critical 19–25. Controls are selected following the hierarchy: Elimination !' Substitution !' Engineering controls !' Administrative controls !' PPE. Assessments are reviewed annually and following any incident, near-miss, or significant operational change.

RISK	PRIMARY CONTROLS
Display Screen Equipment — prolonged screen use	Workstation self-assessment; 20-20-20 rule; minimum 5-min break per hour; adjustable equipment provision
Sedentary work and musculoskeletal disorders	Standing desk options; movement break prompts; ergonomics guidance in staff onboarding
Work-related stress and mental wellbeing	Workload monitoring; regular 1:1 check-ins; EAP signposting; mental health first aid resources
Information security and data breach	Information Security Policy; MFA; encrypted storage; access controls; incident response procedure
Inaccurate safety-critical course content	Annual content audit by qualified SME; version control; rapid correction procedure; IIRSM review cycle
Contractor competence failure	Pre-engagement competence and insurance verification; written scope of work; supervision where required
Lone working — remote staff	Regular check-in schedule; emergency contact register; escalation if check-in missed
Cyber incident / platform unavailability	Business Continuity Plan; offsite backups; incident response procedure; supplier SLA monitoring

6. WORKER CONSULTATION AND PARTICIPATION

All workers are entitled and actively encouraged to: raise health and safety concerns without fear of detriment; participate in risk assessments relevant to their own activities; propose improvements; and access all health and safety documents including this policy, risk assessments, and incident records. All concerns are acknowledged within 2 working days and fully investigated within 10 working days. Outcomes are communicated to the worker and logged in the near-miss/incident register.

7. COMPETENCE, TRAINING, AND AWARENESS

All personnel receive health and safety induction covering this policy, emergency procedures, role-specific risks, and incident reporting. Ongoing competence is maintained through: annual health and safety briefings; role-specific training (DSE assessment, first aid, fire safety) with records in the Competence and Training Register; external CPD for content authors including maintenance of NPTC qualifications; and pre-engagement competence verification for all contractors.

8. COMMUNICATION

Health and safety information is communicated through: this policy document, issued to all staff and contractors on engagement and reissued following review; health and safety briefings at onboarding and as required; prompt

email notification of urgent safety-critical matters; and through the Chainsaw Courses platform, which communicates safety requirements to learners via course content, the digital waiver, and the AI mock examiner.

9. OPERATIONAL PLANNING AND CONTROL

- All new work activities are subject to a risk assessment before commencement.
- All contractors undergo a pre-engagement competence review (see Supplier and Contractor Evaluation Policy).
- All changes to safety-critical course content are subject to the Document Control Procedure and require Director sign-off.
- Platform downtime and cyber incidents are managed under the Business Continuity and Disaster Recovery Plan.
- All staff working with display screen equipment for more than 1 hour per day maintain a current DSE self-assessment, reviewed annually.

10. EMERGENCY PREPAREDNESS AND RESPONSE

Emergency arrangements are detailed in the Emergency Preparedness and Response Procedure. As a remote-first organisation, key provisions are: cyber incident response (Data Breach and Incident Response Procedure); remote worker safety via emergency contact register and lone worker check-in protocol; and escalation to emergency services (999/NHS 111) for personal medical emergencies. Emergency procedures are reviewed annually and following any activation.

11. INCIDENT REPORTING, INVESTIGATION, AND RIDDOR

All incidents, near-misses, dangerous occurrences, and work-related ill-health events must be reported to the Director within 24 hours. Investigation is conducted under the Incident and Near-Miss Reporting Procedure. RIDDOR notifications to the HSE are submitted without delay for: deaths and specified injuries; over-7-day incapacitation; dangerous occurrences; and diagnosed occupational diseases. All RIDDOR records are retained for a minimum of 10 years.

12. PERFORMANCE MONITORING

INDICATOR	TARGET
RIDDOR-reportable incidents	Zero — reviewed at every management review
Near-miss reports investigated on time	100% within 10 working days
DSE self-assessments current	100% of qualifying staff — reviewed annually
Risk assessments reviewed on schedule	100% — tracked in Risk Register
H&S training completion	100% — tracked in Competence Register
Contractor competence verified before engagement	100% — tracked in Supplier Register
Safety-critical content accuracy issues resolved	Acknowledged "d2 working days; resolved "d5 working days

13. MANAGEMENT REVIEW

The Director conducts a formal management review of health and safety performance at least annually, covering: KPI performance; incident and near-miss trends; outstanding corrective actions; legislative changes; audit results; and worker feedback. Review outputs include updated objectives, policy changes, and resource decisions. Management review minutes are retained for a minimum of 7 years.

14. CONTINUAL IMPROVEMENT AND POLICY REVIEW

This policy is reviewed annually as part of the management review, immediately following any significant incident, in response to legislative changes, and following feedback from workers or auditors. Previous versions are retained in the Document Register for a minimum of 7 years. Controlled under reference HSW-001.

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